

John Terry

Intermediate Team Faculty

Mary, Star of the Sea School

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Syllabus: 2026-2027 Grade 5 Social Studies

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?"

Welcome to Grade 5! This syllabus is intended to help you, the student, develop a greater understanding of what we will cover, what is expected of you, and what you can expect from me.

Schoolwide Learning Expectations (SLEs): Self-Aware, Confident Individuals; Teachable Life-Long Learners; Active Christians; Responsible Citizens

Living Our NUI Mission

A supportive environment is essential for student growth and achievement. Students are expected to act respectfully towards other students and to respond to each other's ideas and work with thoughtful comments, positive encouragement, and constructive feedback. Students are expected to be attentive, to work diligently during class, and to follow all classroom rules and directions.

Social Studies Course Overview:

My primary focus this year is that all students develop a love for — and grade-level understanding of — U.S. history, develop critical-thinking skills, and use historical evidence to formulate an argument.

Students will learn about the history of people in North America beginning with the first indigenous tribes and ending with Manifest Destiny and the expansion of the United States across the continent. Students will explore important themes throughout our history, engage in research and analysis of historical events, and participate in cross-curricular projects using other subjects such as English and Art.

TEXTBOOK:

- MyWorld Interactive (Social Studies)

SOCIAL STUDIES GRADING POLICY:

- 30% Tests
- 30% Classwork and Participation
- 20% Quizzes
- 20% Homework

*Parents, please note: You will have access to my electronic gradebook via your Beehively account, which will be a primary method of communicating your child's academic performance. It will be assumed that you have seen all grades and missing assignments that are entered in Beehively.

CURRICULUM — Grade 5 Social Studies

- Quarter 1: Unit 1 — The First Americans · Unit 2 — Age of Exploration · Unit 3 — Settling the Colonies in North America
- Quarter 2: Unit 4 — Life in the Colonies · Unit 5 — The American Revolution
- Quarter 3: Unit 6 — A New Nation · Unit 7 — Life in the Young Republic
- Quarter 4: Unit 8 — Westward Expansion · Unit 9 — Civil War and Reconstruction (Parts 1 & 2)

HOMEWORK POLICY:

Homework that is given will not be for students to explore new concepts. Homework will strictly be to reinforce concepts that have already been taught in class, including research for projects. It is used as more of a “completion” grade.

Your children's teachers will work together to ensure that the students receive a balanced homework regime aimed at creating a positive learning environment that nurtures students' intellectual growth.

Late Work / Extra Credit:

- All late work must be turned in within one week of when it was assigned. Students will receive 70% on late work turned in.
- Extra credit is not offered. However, during the last week of each quarter, students may turn in any missing or incomplete work for partial credit (60%).
- 10% will be taken off of project grades for late submissions.

COMMUNICATION:

The best way to communicate with a teacher is by email. Students will be sent home with a white envelope on Tuesdays that has updated work and various other documents regarding events at school.

Updates will also be sent out via Beehively, our electronic communication and grading portal. Announcements posted to Beehively are sent directly to your email, as well as important upcoming assignments and events.

MATERIALS:

- Composition Notebook (3)
- Pencils — colored and regular
- Red pen
- Highlighter
- HMH textbook
- Headphones, mouse

There will be times we do STEM projects that will require additional materials to be brought in, such as soda bottles, construction paper, balloons, etc.

CLASSROOM EXPECTATIONS:

- Students come to class prepared and ready to learn each day.
- Homework should be completed on time. If circumstances prevent completion, students should communicate with the teacher in advance so that an appropriate plan can be made.
- Everyone is encouraged to participate by asking questions, contributing ideas, and seeking clarification from the teacher when needed.
- We will treat ourselves, one another, and school property with respect and responsibility.

TEACHER CONTACT

- Contact me via email: jterry@starofthesea.org
- Please allow up to 24 hours for a response on school days.
- In-person office hours: 2:45–3:15 p.m. (M–F)

Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith